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Quiz 1: Subagent Concepts

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Test your understanding of subagent patterns, architectures, and when to use them.

Question 1: What is a subagent?

- [ ] A subagent is a different agent platform (like switching from Claude Code to Codex)
- [ ] A subagent is a skill that runs in the background while the main agent works on something else
- [x] A subagent is a child agent process spawned by a parent agent to handle a subtask in isolation, then report results back

Correct! Correct! Subagents are independent processes that solve specific subtasks and communicate results to the parent.

- [ ] A subagent is a way to run the same agent twice for redundancy

Submit **You got all the answers!**

Question 2: What is the fan-out / fan-in pattern?

- [ ] Fan-out/fan-in spawns multiple subagents, each handling a sequential stage; each stage waits for the previous to finish
- [x] Fan-out/fan-in spawns multiple independent subagents in parallel, waits for all to finish, then combines results

Correct! Correct! All work happens simultaneously. Perfect for independent tasks.

- [ ] Fan-out/fan-in requires a supervisor agent to coo

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- [ ] Fan-out/fan-in is the only pattern you should ever use

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Question 3: What is the pipeline pattern?

- [ ] Pipeline pattern runs all subagents in parallel to maximize speed
- [x] Pipeline pattern chains subagents sequentially, where each stage's output becomes the next stage's input

Correct! Correct! Pipelines are for sequential workflows like design → code → test.

- [ ] Pipeline pattern requires 10+ subagents to be effective
- [ ] Pipeline and fan-out/fan-in are the same thing

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Question 4: When should you reach for subagents?

- [x] Use subagents when you have 10+ files to read or 3+ independent pieces of work

Correct! Correct! The blog post identifies these as the strong signals for subagent use.

- [ ] Always use subagents if your task takes more than 1 minute
- [ ] Use subagents only for parallel work; never for sequential tasks
- [ ] Use subagents for every task; they always make things faster

Submit **You got all the answers!**

Question 5: What is the supervisor pattern?

- [ ] Supervisor pattern spawns all subagents in parallel to maximize speed
- [x] Supervisor pattern has a parent agent directing multiple specialist subagents, each with different tools and expertise

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Correct! Correct! Supervisor is for when you need multiple specialized agents working on the same problem.

- [ ] Supervisor pattern requires more than 10 subagents to be effective
- [ ] Supervisor pattern means all subagents have identical tools

Submit **You got all the answers!**

Summary

If you got 4-5 correct, the core subagent patterns are in place. If not, revisit the patterns lesson before moving into the hands-on workflow.

Key Takeaways

- Subagents are isolated child agents, not separate platforms or background skills
- Fan-out / fan-in is parallel; pipeline is sequential; supervisor coordinates specialists
- The best signal for subagents is independent or clearly staged work that justifies the coordination overhead

Next Steps

Next, put these patterns to work in the hands-on multi-agent workflow.

</> Update on GitHub

← Using Subagents Hands-On: Multi-Agent Workflow →

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